

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

## CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



### Let's Start!

Let's talk about a crazy story!



### Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

### Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships, character traits and strange events.
- I can express regret or uncertainty in the past.
- I can talk about a repeated past action.

### Ask your partner:

- Do you have any unusual stories from your childhood?
- What is the craziest story you have ever heard?



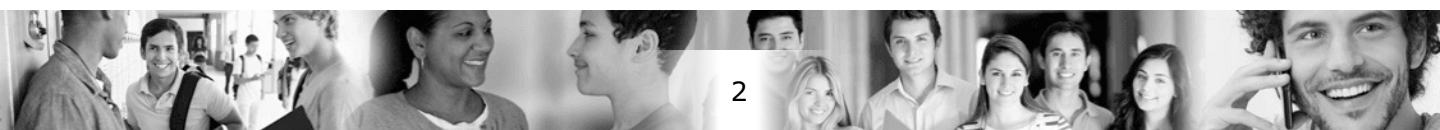


## Let's Explore!

Amy describes a strange event that happened on the way home from a basketball game.

*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

- Amy:** It's really coming down out here. It reminds of a time when my mom tried to drive home in a whiteout.
- Vanessa:** I'm sorry, dear. What is a whiteout?
- Amy:** In the winter, it's when the snow-covered countryside is indistinguishable from the road due to the wind whipping up the snow.
- Vanessa:** Got it.
- Amy:** So one night my mother was driving my brother and I home from his basketball game in another county. It had snowed a lot all week. We were driving on some small Kansas road.
- Peter:** Wait! You are from Kansas?
- Amy:** Yeah, Lucas, Kansas.
- Peter:** Yee-haw!
- Amy:** Anyway, as mom was driving the wind was starting to blow. The snow was swirling around the car and it was becoming impossible to see.
- Peter:** Did you pull over?
- Vanessa:** They couldn't have pulled over.
- Amy:** Right. It's too dangerous. We couldn't have stopped because the other cars coming wouldn't see us and they'd crash into the back of us.
- Peter:** So what did you do?
- Amy:** We kept driving. My mother was doing her best to see the road while driving and maintaining a constant speed.
- Peter:** What were you doing while your mom was driving?
- Amy:** Nothing. My brother, John wasn't talking, and I wasn't talking either. We were scared. Finally, up ahead, we saw a pair of tail lights through the whiteout. They shone like a demon's eyes, but these lights were our saviors.
- Vanessa:** Right, because you could have just followed them.
- Amy:** Exactly! So we followed the tail lights wherever they went. We had been driving for a while, when the truck in front of us suddenly stopped.
- Vanessa:** Oh, no! Other cars behind you could have hit you.
- Amy:** My mom slammed on the brakes. She was yelling, "You can't stop here. You are going to get us killed!"
- Peter:** What happened?
- Amy:** Mom started honking the horn loudly. Finally, a man got out of the truck and walked back to our car. My mom rolled down the window and screamed, "You can't stop here." The man replied, "Sure, I can." My mom exclaimed, "Why?" To which the man responded, "Because I'm home."
- Vanessa:** WOW!
- Peter:** Wait! That story couldn't have happened!
- Amy:** Yeaah ... ha!





## Let's Practice!

They shone like a demon's eyes, but these lights were our saviors.

*Instructions: Use the correct option from the box to fill the blanks in the paragraph. Read the paragraph aloud. Compare yourself to a partner. Correct each other.*

### Word Bank

saviors / demon's / killed / horn / honking / driving / truck  
/ screamed / rolled / whiteout / reminds

It \_\_\_\_\_ me of a time when my mom tried to drive home in a  
\_\_\_\_\_. My mom \_\_\_\_\_ down the window and  
\_\_\_\_\_, "You can't stop here." We had been  
\_\_\_\_\_ for a while, when the \_\_\_\_\_ in front of  
us suddenly stopped. Mom started \_\_\_\_\_ the  
\_\_\_\_\_ loudly. You are going to get us all  
\_\_\_\_\_. After a while, my mom saw some lights which shone like a  
\_\_\_\_\_ eyes, but those lights were our \_\_\_\_\_.



## Let's Practice!

Catherine recounts a story.

*Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences.*

### Word Bank

was starting / was maintaining / you doing / was becoming / was  
swirling / was doing / driving / was driving / wasn't talking

As Mom \_\_\_\_\_ the wind \_\_\_\_\_ to blow. The snow  
\_\_\_\_\_ around the car and it \_\_\_\_\_ impossible to see. My  
mother \_\_\_\_\_ her best to see the road while driving and \_\_\_\_\_  
a constant speed. What were \_\_\_\_\_ while your mom was  
\_\_\_\_\_ ? My brother, John \_\_\_\_\_, and I wasn't talking either.





## Extension Activity

The police are investigating a robbery!

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Yesterday there was a robbery at the school between 6:00 p.m. and 9:00 p.m. The police are asking the students for information.
- With your group, brainstorm different questions that you think the police might ask.
- In a group of 4, have one student be a police officer and the other members of the group be students.
- The police officer will ask the students what they were doing yesterday between 6:00 p.m. and 9:00 p.m.
- The students will tell the police officer what they were doing. (You may say whatever you want.)
- After asking all the questions, the police officer will decide who he thinks is a suspect in the robbery.

### Self-Assessment

Yes No

I brainstorm possible police questions.

☐ ☐

I use the Past Continuous tense to make questions.

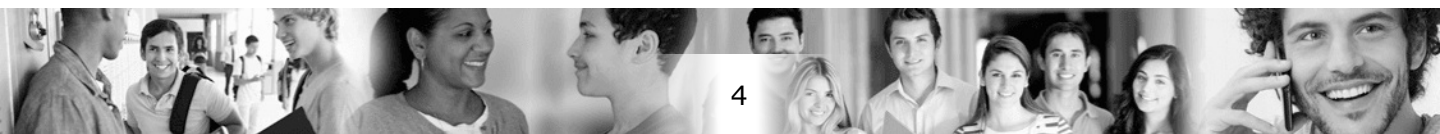
☐ ☐

I use the Past Continuous tense and the Simple Past tense to talk about what I was doing.

☐ ☐


## Target Words

- whiteout** (noun): when illumination from snow on the ground and from a low cloud layer makes features of the landscape indistinguishable  
e.g. It reminds of a time when my mom tried to drive home in a whiteout.
- to come down** (expression): falling down to the ground, especially in large amounts  
e.g. It's really coming down out there.
- indistinguishable** (adjective): not able to be identified as different or distinct  
e.g. It's when the snow-covered countryside is indistinguishable from the road due to the wind whipping up the snow.
- to whip up** (verb): quickly and forcefully put something together  
e.g. It's when the snow-covered countryside is indistinguishable from the road due to the wind whipping up the snow.
- county** (noun): an administrative division in a state or country  
e.g. So one night my mother was driving my brother and I home from his basketball game in another county.
- to pull over** (verb): to move to the side of or off the road  
e.g. They couldn't have pulled over.
- to roll down** (verb): to lower  
e.g. My mom rolled down the window and screamed.





## Learning Points

### Expressing Regret and Uncertainty in The Past: Should Have

You use the modal phrase **should have** to express regret and uncertainty about the past.

You use **should have + past participle** to talk about something that would have been a good idea, but you didn't do it (in other words, when you regret something).

For example:

*I should have tried harder in school.*

You use **shouldn't have + past participle** to talk about something that wasn't a good idea, but you did it anyway (in other words, you regret something).

For example:

*You shouldn't have gone out last night - now you're too tired to work.*

You can also use **should have + past participle** to talk about something that, if everything is normal and okay, you think has already happened. It's often used with 'by now'.

For example:

*Joe should have finished the test by now.*

### Examples:

- *They couldn't have pulled over.*
- *That story couldn't have happened!*
- *Other cars behind you could have hit you.*
- *You could have just followed them.*
- *We couldn't have stopped because the other cars coming wouldn't see us.*





## Learning Points

### The Past Continuous vs. The Simple Past

You use the **Simple Past**, not the **Past Continuous**, to talk about repeated actions in the past.

For example:

*We went to Japan four times last year.*

When you want to emphasize that repeated actions continued for a temporary period of time, you can use the **Past Continuous**.

For example:

*When my grandmother was sick, we were visiting her every day.*

#### Examples:

- *My mother was doing her best to see the road while driving and maintaining a constant speed.*
- *What were you doing while your mom was driving?*
- *My brother, John wasn't talking, and I wasn't talking either.*
- *As mom was driving the wind was starting to blow.*
- *The snow was swirling around the car and it was becoming impossible to see.*

